focus of the mainstream discipline in economic (market) theory. Externalities, many economists say, either do not bother or should be internalised in order to make them calculable and thus to improve the economic rationality of market decisions. Externalities are an inevitable result of joint production, and there is on Earth no non-joint production – due to the law of entropy. Thermodynamic physics clearly shows that the output of a production process is, on the sunny side, values, and on the dark side emissions in the atmosphere, the waters and the ground. Economists have an eye on the bright side, but they are very reluctant to shed light on the dark side. The question comes up: How can one internalise a process and its effects economically which physically cannot be internalised?

The double character of all economic processes offers a helpful suggestion. The physical and thus material external effects must not be internalised, nor the positive and the negative ones. It is, however, possible to internalise the transactions on the value side of the economy by making use of the money form of market processes. It is possible to give environmental damages a price, although its meaningfulness is more than doubtful. What is the price of an extinguished species, how can one calculate the costs of the heatwave in 2005 in Europe with some ten thousand people dead? There is no rational answer to this question.

Nonetheless, financial market agents invented financial market innovations which are apt to internalise externalities and thus to calculate the incalculable: securities and other forms of payment for so-called ecosystems services, certificates on pollution rights, etc. New financial instruments are on the political agenda (TEEB – The Economics of Ecosystems and the Biosphere; PES – Payments for Ecosystem Services; REDD – Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation). The consequence is that natural limits seem to disappear in a monetary calculation where the complexity of nature is simplified to a cost-benefit comparison. Natural limits in this discourse are transformed into market opportunities and sold in booming global financial markets. Organised in such a manner, environmental policy perfectly fits into the market system. Due to financial innovations, the harm done to nature by crossing the limits of growth (and thus of nature) can be monetised and traded in financial markets. The disembedding of the capitalist market economy from society and nature is nearly perfect. The natural nature disappears, the monetised nature arises. If it were not for the material aspect of the externalities, the capitalist trajectory could be a perennial success story.

However, the planetary boundaries are resistant to the neoliberal attempts of internalisation. The world is facing an exhaustion of natural resources. Peak oil is a permanent threat which cannot be reduced by exploring non-conventional